

• **A sense of achievement** Plants can boost self-esteem. To see a living thing thrive thanks to your care and attention evokes a feeling of pride. And success in the form of propagation or seeing your plant flower releases serotonin, another hormone that lifts and stabilizes your mood.

• **A healthy relationship** There is evidence to show that plants can have a positive impact on those suffering from eating disorders, as their focus is shifted to caring for another living thing. The situation needs to be handled sensitively, but, with support, the final aim is to see the person growing their own lettuce, peppers, herbs, and mushrooms indoors to help encourage a positive relationship with food.

Homeliness

Plants can enliven your home and bring comfort and positivity, too.

• **Visual therapy** Introducing plants to a room can benefit those who are living with post-traumatic stress disorder (PTSD), as changing the appearance of your space is encouraged as a form of therapy.

• **A breath of fresh air** Plants can prompt us to let light and air into a room. Opening windows encourages fresh airflow, while birdsong from outside will lift the mood and distract from negative thoughts.

• **The living home** Humans are living things. We are hardwired to be close to the



*King begonias
have zesty
edible flowers*

*Aloe vera sap
has skin-soothing
properties*



A healthy home

Plants can offer visual respite, provide edible treats, and encourage us to bring fresh air into our homes, boosting our mental and physical health in the process.